

Danielle is getting married in a few months. The moment I got the invitation, I called her up and insisted she get a prenup. Because of Wicked Good Cupcakes, Dani is a wealthy 20-something, and in my opinion, she's going into this marriage with a lot more at stake than the man she's marrying. I'm sure he's a great guy, but I always advise young people to safeguard their financial dynasties.

Elaine Tan Comeau of Easy Daysies Ltd. holds a special place in the *Dragons' Den* hall of fame: she's one of a select few who have incited a bidding war between all five Dragons. Her product was a visual daily routine for kids, a simple magnetic schedule that parents could stick up on the fridge, allowing their children to check off items on their daily "to do" list. Elaine's visual routines were already winning awards by the time she came on the show. She made a great presentation of Easy Daysies, aided by her husband, Ron, and three small children. A self-proclaimed "mom-preneur," Elaine was an investor's dream. Jim Treliving and I went in on a deal together, and though the competition was stiff, we won.

Easy Daysies came from what Elaine calls "the spark of a simple idea." An elementary school teacher, she had been using visual routines with her students in the classroom for eight years. After enough parents asked her to make something for their kids at home, she realized there might be an actual market for her product. She needed \$1,400 to make the first batch, so she sold handmade crafts and did extra tutoring until she met her goal. Elaine assembled her first batch of product on her kitchen table between the hours of midnight and 3 A.M., launching Easy Daysies two days after giving birth to her third child. Needless to say, she wasn't getting much sleep!

Before long, Easy Daysies had become the number one Back-to-School Must-Have in *Parents* magazine, and the incoming orders far exceeded the capacity of the Comeaus' kitchen table. Elaine found her way onto *Dragons' Den*, and Jim and I funded the next stage of her business. The rest, as they say, is history.